



Q

Why do you need to add bottled lemon juice or citric acid when canning tomatoes at home?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To increase acidity and ensure safe canning

FUN FACT

Tomatoes are borderline acidic, so lemon juice or citric acid helps keep them safe for canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

How much bottled lemon juice should you add per quart jar of tomatoes for safe canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

2 tablespoons

FUN FACT

Using the right amount of acid keeps harmful bacteria from growing in canned tomatoes.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

Why must you follow tested salsa recipes exactly when canning at home?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Changing ingredients affects acidity and safety

FUN FACT

Even small ingredient changes can make salsa unsafe to can at home.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the main reason that boiling water canners and pressure canners are used for canning tomatoes and salsas?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To destroy microorganisms that cause spoilage and illness

FUN FACT

The right heat kills harmful bacteria and makes canned foods safe to eat later.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Teens (14–18)

Q

What should you do before removing skins from tomatoes for canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Dip in boiling water for 30-60 seconds until skins split

FUN FACT

This quick hot water dip loosens the tomato skins to peel easily.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

When handling hot peppers for salsa canning, what safety advice must you follow?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Wear gloves and avoid touching your face

FUN FACT

Capsaicin in hot peppers can irritate skin and eyes if you're not careful.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the recommended headspace to leave in jars when adding salsa to be canned?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1/2 inch

FUN FACT

Proper headspace lets food expand and steam circulate during canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

Which of these is NOT safe to increase in proportion when making tested spaghetti sauce recipes for canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Onions, celery, peppers, or mushrooms

FUN FACT

Changing vegetable amounts can alter safety by changing acidity or density.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

**Why is salt added to
canned tomato products?**



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

For flavor only, not for preservation

FUN FACT

Salt can be left out if you need a low-sodium option without safety risks.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What must you do with the jar rims before putting on lids when canning tomatoes or salsa?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Wipe clean with a damp cloth to remove food particles

FUN FACT

Clean jar rims help lids seal tightly and prevent spoilage.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

How long should salsa be simmered before filling jars when canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

**At least 10 to 20 minutes
depending on recipe**

FUN FACT

*Cooking salsa well helps blend flavors
and ensures safe hot packing.*

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the important safety tip for processing times when canning salsa at different altitudes?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Increase processing time or pressure at higher altitudes

FUN FACT

Water boils at lower temperatures at high altitudes, so longer processing ensures safety.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the recommended jar size for safely canning tomato products?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Standard Mason-type jars designed for home canning

FUN FACT

Using proper jars ensures lids can seal tightly during processing.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

Which ingredient can you substitute for bottled lemon juice in canning tomatoes?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Bottled lime juice (not key lime juice)

FUN FACT

Bottled juices have consistent acidity needed for safe canning.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Teens (14–18)

Q

Why is it risky to use overripe or frost-killed tomatoes for canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

They can cause poor quality and unsafe products

FUN FACT

Only firm, ripe tomatoes from healthy vines should be canned for safety.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What heating method is used to process salsa jars safely at home?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Boiling water canner for 15 minutes or more depending on altitude

FUN FACT

Boiling water canners provide the right temperature to kill harmful germs.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What is the key reason for thoroughly washing tomatoes before canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To remove dirt and bacteria on the surface

FUN FACT

Clean tomatoes start the preservation process safely and improve jar sealing.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

Which acid is usually NOT recommended for adding to canned tomatoes due to flavor changes?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Vinegar

FUN FACT

Vinegar can change the taste, so bottled lemon juice or citric acid is preferred.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

After processing jars in a water bath canner, how long should you wait before moving the jars?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Wait 5 minutes after removing the canner lid

FUN FACT

Waiting lets pressure stabilize and prevents jar breakage.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



Q

What protective equipment is recommended when handling hot peppers for salsa canning?



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Plastic or rubber gloves

FUN FACT

Gloves protect your skin from the burning oils in hot peppers.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables